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TUESDAY, APRIL 28, 2026

A distressing look at child abuse in facilities

Experts fear more cases not reported in state-licensed sites

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

At a state-licensed residential school for disabled children in Brewster, a vocational teacher raped a student repeatedly, including once at the teacher's home.
At a facility in Pittsfield, a

worker discussed having sex with a teenager after the resident turned 18 amid a pattern of grooming behavior. That youth wrote of the worker in a journal, "Don't ever forget me! Remember our deal && plan when I'm 18."
At a residential program

for troubled youth in Stoughton, a mental health provider arranged hotel rendezvous for sex with a youth in their care — and brought the teen alcohol and \$1,000 in money and gifts.

Over a three-year span, from August 2022 through August 2025, state officials identified 20 instances of workers engaging in sexual misconduct with children and

20
number of instances of workers engaging in sexual misconduct with children and young adults who were or had been in their care from 2022-2025

young adults who were or had been in their care, according to a Globe review of state records. The incidents included sexual comments, inappropriate touching, grooming, and rape. Throughout most of that period, investigators identified credible accounts of child sexual mistreatment almost once every six weeks.

The Office of the Child Ad-
DCF, Page A6

Wu on climate: Time for action

New plan keeps emissions targets, implements policies, explores congestion pricing

By Kate Selig
GLOBE STAFF

Boston Mayor Michelle Wu on Monday unveiled a climate action plan for the city to curb planet-warming emissions while combating heat, flooding, and other harmful effects of climate change.

The plan charts a path to slash emissions in half by 2030 and achieve carbon neutrality by 2050, including by exploring controversial policies such as congestion pricing for car traffic. The plan maintains the same climate targets set by Wu's predecessor, Mayor Martin J. Walsh, in 2017, and is more focused on implementing and growing existing initiatives than creating ones. Many of the programs cited in the report are presented as avenues to explore, not new policies to implement in the short term.

Wu, who ran as a champion for climate issues, faced criticism early in her tenure for not moving faster on an environmental policy, and did not release a climate plan until her second term. Wu allies said Monday the new plan delivers the comprehensive agenda they had been waiting for and lays out a clear path to achieving the city's long-held emissions targets.

CLIMATE, Page A10



Mother told officers she strangled children, police say

Wellesley woman to be extradited from Vt. as details of tragedy emerge

By Paul Heintz,
Sarah Rahal, Lea Skene,
and John R. Ellement
GLOBE STAFF

WELLESLEY — The woman was distraught, arriving unexpectedly at her aunt's house in southern Vermont with a bloody gash and a chilling revelation: She had killed her two young children in their Wellesley home before attempting suicide.

Janette MacAusland, 49, who allegedly told police she strangled the children, appeared in court in Vermont on Monday, where she agreed to be extradited back to Massachusetts to face mur-



der charges.

A police report in Vermont and court documents reveal new details about the case, which stunned MacAusland's community since the children's bodies were discovered late Friday night, leaving parents of their classmates wondering how to explain an unimaginable tragedy to elementary schoolers.

After the killings, MacAusland allegedly drove to Bennington and knocked on her aunt's window. MacAusland then revealed that she'd killed her children, Ella and Kai, ages 7 and 6, according to the
WELLESLEY, Page A7



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Mourners, including Patti Curran (top), stopped and left tributes and notes at the Edgemoor Avenue home of the slain children in Wellesley. At left, Janette MacAusland is being held in a Vermont facility.

'I was left unprotected'

Female golfer's allegations of harassment sets students, administrators on edge

By Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

When Charlotte Rollins made her high school's varsity golf team this school year, her dreams of playing Division 1 at a top university seemed to inch ever closer.

But what began as a milestone season for the freshman soon unraveled.

Rollins, the only girl on the co-ed team at Masconomet Regional High in Boxford, alleged she was subjected to bullying and harassment from her teammates and unequal treatment as a player based on her gender. Within a few months, her parents filed a Title IX complaint with the school district.

The situation escalated after the complaint was filed, the family said. In the school hallways, male athletes made sexually explicit comments about Charlotte, they claimed. A varsity hockey player threatened her with sexual violence in the locker room in front of multiple teammates, some of whom had played on the junior varsity and varsity golf teams, they alleged.

Earlier this month, the 15-year-old recounted the alleged mistreatment to a shocked School Committee and said she was changing schools at the end of the academic year. Rollins, who de-
GOLF, Page A10

In Cambridge, start spreading the news

Outlets battle for eyes, precious market share

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — Four years ago, there were no full-time reporters dedicated to covering Cambridge, a troubling sign that even a city reputed for world-class universities and cutting-edge biotech firms could resemble a news desert.

But two new efforts aim to ensure that Cantabrigians have reliable news for years to come — albeit after a difficult breakup of one of the town's established news partnerships.

The 17-year old Cambridge Day, which as of 2024 is under nonprofit ownership, brought on editor-in-chief Michael Fitzgerald last year and just hired its first full-time
NEWS, Page A7



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Michael Fitzgerald was named editor-in-chief of Cambridge Day last year.



Sun thing, else

Tuesday: Mostly sunny.
High 53-58, low 41-46.

Wednesday: Clouds, rain late.
High 48-53, low 43-48.

Weather and comics, **D5-6**.
Obituaries, **C9**.

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Prosecutors detail plot for assassination

Officials charged California man with attempting to kill President Trump at a week-end press gala. **A4**.

Labor friction continued in local hospitals: Tufts nurses held a no-confidence vote in an operating room manager, and unions at the former Good Samaritan Hospital held off on strike plans as talks advanced. **D1**.

The Red Sox's decision to also fire several coaches along with manager Alex Cora baffles some baseball insiders, Peter Abraham writes. **C1**.